# Acute Respiratory Distress Syndrome – Section Summary

PEEP • Recruitment • Transpulmonary pressure • NMB • Prone

Critical Care Board Review • Section 12 • MCQ-Oriented

## 1. Key Points

- Hypoxaemia → ↑ **PEEP**; high Pplat → ↓ VT
- Recruitment less effective later in ARDS
- Obese/anasarca: negative transpulmonary → ↑ **PEEP**
- Barotrauma (pneumothorax) → decompression; NMB may ↓ pneumothorax
- Severe ARDS: **early cisatracurium 48 h** (ACURASYS)
- Mortality benefit: **prone positioning**; ↓ **driving pressure**
- Fluid overload → **furosemide**

## 2. High-Yield MCQ Pearls

- ☑ Prone saves lives
- ☑ Lower ΔP = survival

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